

# KF26 Expanded Version of Teachings

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Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

**0:01    OPENING**

**0:02    PRESENTING**

**0:06    KARIS CIRCULATION**

**0:07    GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS**

**0:08    MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING**

A well-known body bio-mechanics expert said that *the most important piece of restoring function starts with creating space in your day to heal.*<sup>1</sup> (Repeat) Karis Fellowships meetings are a healing space, and so is your meditation practice.

A KF member wrote about the stages on his journey as he worked toward a satisfying meditation practice. This is what he said:

“My first thought was—I should meditate, but I can’t do it. After a while I learned that it is a challenge to meditate—I will try to do it. I did that for a few weeks, and I realized that meditation helps me—I see value in doing it. Then, with amazement, I was able to see that I need to meditate—I am changed by doing it. After several months I thought I want to meditate—I like to do it. Near the end of the KF training, I understood that meditation is an adventure and wondered what is possible if I continue to do this?”

Let’s continue to practice **Centering Prayer**.<sup>2</sup>

Take a meditation posture. You might try standing during this exercise and see if that works for you. Begin with silent prayer, resting in the spirit and the breath. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

Ask God for a *word*, and allow that word, phrase, or image to rest in your mind. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

Stick to this word during your meditation time. When other thoughts intrude, gently return to your word. Try practicing the balanced breath, using equal amounts of time to inhale and exhale. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

When you are ready, allow the word to float away, and then rest in the stillness of your mind. You might try saying or attending to the word for one breath and then resting in the stillness for two breaths. Breathe. (*Pause for 1 minute*)

And now, practice resting only in the stillness, the quiet mind, for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. Take a full, deep breath as if you were stretching your insides. Gently re-engage with the meeting.

Our scripture for this meditation is Psalm 27:14.

Wait on the Lord;  
Be of good courage,  
And allow your heart to be strengthened.  
Yes, wait on the Lord.

Take a deep breath.

*(Go immediately to the Confession to allow time for the Toolbox)*

## **0:20 KARIS CONFESSION**

## **0:21 TOOLBOX.**

This month we will look at our illusions and how we compulsively cling to them to support our pride, our sense of superiority, and our pursuit of an imagined glory. Illusions are stories that discount or dismiss real evidence, ignore cause and effect, and often help us avoid crushing self-hate. They generate negative emotions, which we then inflict on others, and they torment us with anxieties and fears that depressurize our self-hate. Our neurotic need to hate ourselves invites us to compare our own lives with that of others. We must imagine a kind of hierarchy which portrays others as more admirable, attractive, and luckier than we are, and this neurotic envy propels us to work harder to achieve our search for glory.

Our culture is mesmerized by appearance, talent, and money. I call these attributes the *ATM*. With the same effortless ease that cash can be withdrawn from a machine at the bank, people can draw on their assets of appearance, talent, and money, using the way they dress, the car they drive, the intelligence or artistic skills they possess, and the amount of money at their disposal to create illusions of superiority and success.

The ATM can also be used to project the illusion of helplessness and need. Like someone who has a stash of money but acts as if they have none, a person can give the appearance of being more disadvantaged and less capable than they actually are. These people use the illusion of their poverty to steal from the community.<sup>3</sup> Others use their real poverty to manipulate the community into taking care of them and to avoid taking responsibility for their own lives. They may actively undermine their own lives so that they can justify taking whatever resources are offered or available without returning any demonstration of gratitude. They then squander any resources they have or receive because if they were to use them to improve their condition, they would have no reason to assert their claims. Their poverty supports their pride system and gives them an illusion of power.

The ATM of appearance, talent, and money is often determined by antecedents and energetic flow, but the people who draw on it live in the illusion that these qualities, or the lack of them, entitle them to preference or even deference. The really sad thing is that people who regularly rely on the power of their ATM find it much more difficult to develop their True Self.

Of course, we are all encouraged to buy into the illusions of the ATM. Our society feeds on our Idol's search for glory and trains us to be mesmerized and coerced by appearance, talent, and money. We can be perfectly rational beings, living by Biblical principles, and then suddenly find ourselves compromising who we are or scrambling to regain our equilibrium in the face of a compelling ATM. Sometimes we are envious that someone else—even someone we have only read about—has what we want. We find ourselves thinking, "If only I were like them," and then go on to use our beautiful minds to wallow in the pain of those imagined possibilities. We might feel fear or show deference when a person with a big ATM balance comes into the room. This is called *partiality*. So, when you find yourself judging or showing deference toward someone, you might ask yourself: *Am I acting out of partiality? Am I reacting to the ATM?*

It is not only the appearance of wealth that clouds our ability to make principled decisions. The appearance of poverty can also interfere with our ability to maintain orientation. Our culture often pressures us to show partiality toward people who appear to be in need. However, these people may be projecting a small ATM to create the illusion of helplessness. We then feel obligated to rescue them in order to relieve the tension and guilt of our shoulders—and that sense of obligation is often compulsive. We may even feel superior and confident in our condescension toward a needy person and then bask in the illusion that we are amazing or worthwhile people. When we are being helpful, we feel the euphoria of having value. That makes us crave being helpful.

The ethos of Karis Fellowships is very different from the culture of our market economy, which is based on contracts and the ATM. Our ministry simply aspires to empower all Christians who want to recover their True Self for the glory of God. KF is not a need-based ministry; it is *effort-based*. This is extremely important. It is the effort you make to recover your True Self and build karis relationships that reveals your true intention. Your ATM balance is not important in the karis economy; it is your effort, not your need or your wealth, that invites support and care from other KF members. We gain strength through fellowship with others as together we stagger toward the goal of developing a strong and resilient True Self. We invest in effort-based people so that when our True Self starts to run, we can run with those who are also running. This is a new kind of race in which we all start weak but end strong.

We will now use the **T-A-T** to explore the issue of money.<sup>4</sup> You may have watched Alison's demonstration of the **T-A-T** on [Alison's tapping and TAT videos](#). Bring to mind an aspect of money that is uncomfortable for you. Perhaps you define yourself by your wealth, or even by your poverty. You may be unable to save or circulate. Perhaps you are in debt or feel anxious or guilty about what you have. You may be unable to spend or earn, or to stop spending or earning, and you may not be able to recognize the cause and effect between your work and your finances. Perhaps you resist the limitations of money.

The goal of this Toolbox is to learn to use the **T-A-T** without my guidance, wherever and whenever you need it. Remember to breathe deeply. Oxygen helps your body heal. You can always use a long exhaling breath or the Dragon Breath to process whatever you are feeling.

### **The T-A-T**

Grasp the bridge of your nose with your ring finger and thumb. Gently press the third finger into the center of your forehead just above the nose. In this training session we will spend two minutes on each step. Feel free to continue holding the pose rather than writing down your thoughts. Just do whatever is most helpful for you.

Let's begin. Take the pose, and breathe.

**1. Choose an issue or problem. (Pause) (Repeat the instruction)**

During this first step, imagine a problem, a craving, or any illusion you might have about money. How does it feel to spend, earn, give, or receive? How much money is enough for you? How much is too much? When does money make you feel uncomfortable? Allow yourself to feel whatever feelings you have about money. What judgments do you make and what stories do you tell? If you can, experience in your body the sensations associated with money, and breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. On a scale of one to ten, rate the intensity of the craving, discomfort, or resistance you might feel about confronting this problem. Very uncomfortable feelings would rate as a ten. Jot down a few words that will help you remember what you thought and felt about the problem. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Take the pose again, and breathe.

**2. Imagine how you would think and feel, and what your life would be like, if you did not have this problem or illusion about money. (Pause for 1 minute) (Repeat the instruction) (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. You might wish to jot down a few notes.

Take the pose again, and breathe.

**3. Listen to this clearing statement: "God, thank You for healing the origins of this problem." (Pause for 1 minute) "The origins of this problem are healing now." (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause, and if you wish, jot down your feelings or thoughts.

Take the pose again, and breathe deeply.

**4. Listen to the clearing statement: "God, thank You for healing all the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem." (Pause for 1 minute) "All the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem are healing now." (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. If you have any thoughts or feelings about that, write them down now.

Take the pose again, and breathe.

**5. Listen to the clearing statement: "God, thank You for healing all the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem." (Pause for 1 minute) "All the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem are healing now." (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. If you have any thoughts or feelings, you might write them down now.

The next step leads us into forgiveness. The Greeks used financial terms to describe the dynamics of relationships, and the Greek word often translated as *forgive* means to *release from debt*. Unforgiveness is unhealthy. When you experience loss or feel that someone owes you something and you judge that as bad, something gets stuck in your soul. You are holding on to this thing, but it doesn't belong to you, so it is clogging you up and interfering with the development of others. When you are in unforgiveness, you

don't want to take any responsibility for how you feel. You are intent on saving your Idol's life and restoring your pride and must, therefore, hold something or someone else responsible for your reactions. Send whatever has got stuck by your judgment into the Creation where it is free to circulate and find its way back to whatever or whoever is responsible. Let whatever is stuck go; circulate it, and trust that it will find its way back to where it belongs.

Take the pose, and breathe deeply.

6. **Listen to the clearing statement:** *"I forgive everyone and everything, including God and myself, that I have blamed for this problem."* Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. *(Pause for 1 minute)* *"I release everyone and everything that I have held responsible for this problem."* Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. Write down your thoughts.

And now, for the final step, take the pose and breathe.

7. **Listen to the clearing statement:** *"I ask forgiveness from everyone and everything that I have damaged by holding on to this problem, including God's purposes and my True Self."* Breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)* *"I accept responsibility for the damage that I have caused to anyone or anything by holding on to this problem."* Breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. Make a note of any thoughts you might have.

Write down how you now feel about the problem. On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate the intensity of your discomfort?

Our prayer might go something like this:

*Father of Lights, help me be responsible with the good gift of money.<sup>5</sup> (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")*

## **0:30 SHARING**

## **1:00 BIBLE TEACHING**

KF Confession 6 reminds us of how much energy we have wasted in misoriented living.

We chose to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.

In the last lesson, we talked about how to use our very human gift of imagination in a healthy way. When we have a misoriented response to the ATM, a well-trained imagination can help set us on the Believe It Path. We can learn to appreciate the ATM without judging ourselves or others. Once we are free from the constraining preoccupation with appearances, talent, and money, we can make choices that create oriented outcomes that declare the glory of God. Our understanding of true glory has been influenced by the world's standards of glory, so we are often confused about what our true glory looks like. We have

been created to represent God and to reveal the glory of His character as we fulfill our design as creatures made in His image. This is our glory. As God's children, the basic component of our glory is agape love, and out of that love we can do all kinds of amazing things.

How people feel about money and how they handle money is often a real puzzle, but if we think of money as energy in material form, we can also appreciate why the subject of money and how we use it is so puzzling. The flow of the Creation's energy follows certain pathways, but that harmonious flow is often hindered when it flows through people. In the same way, the flow of money becomes distorted and is aimlessly dissipated when it passes through our misoriented hands. Let's see what James says about the ATM.

This is my paraphrase of **James 2:1–17**.

<sup>1</sup>My siblings, do not abuse the trust of our Lord Jesus Christ—who is committed to real glory—by showing favoritism to others because of the false glory of material appearances. <sup>2</sup>Here is an example: If a gold-ringed man comes into your synagogue in splendid, bright clothing and, also, a beggar enters in filthy clothing, <sup>3</sup>and you gaze upon the one wearing the radiant clothes and say, “You sit here in the good place, a good place that carries with it the symbol of achieved virtue,” and then you say to the beggar, “You stand over there away from me because to be associated with you is social suicide,” or, perhaps, “Sit below my footstool to show that I am superior to you,” <sup>4</sup>are you not distinguishing the rich man from the beggar by your choices and becoming judges using worthless and malicious calculations? <sup>5</sup>Listen, my beloved siblings. Did not God choose the beggars of the world to be rich in trusting God and to be heirs of the kingdom which He promised to anyone who loves Him? <sup>6</sup>But you have judged the beggar to be unworthy based solely on his poverty. Are not the rich gaining control over you and dragging you into court where people are judged by man-made laws, not by God's laws? <sup>7</sup>You put the rich in a seat of virtue, yet do they not vilify and defame the virtuous name of Jesus for which you all have been summoned as witnesses? <sup>8</sup>If, however, you are fulfilling the kingdom law according to the Scripture “Love your neighbor as yourself”, you are a doer of virtue. Doing virtue looks like this: If you are giving up the good place to a rich person of real virtue because he is your neighbor in a karis relationship, you are creating more virtue and orientation. <sup>9</sup>But if you are simply showing partiality based on outward appearances, you are working at misorientation and are in error, and under the kingdom law of God your choices are evidence that you have missed your way.

Take a deep breath.

In this passage, James compares real glory with appearances. Real glory is virtuous action, whereas false glory can be cheaply attributed to others based on no action at all. That is called *partiality*: offering honor to someone who has done nothing to deserve it. We see how the ATM—appearance, talent, and money—can make us partial to those who meet the world's standards. We show partiality because we hope to gain a feeling of self-value from our association with those who look like they have value. James exposes the illusion that partiality will benefit us in some way. The reality is, however, that when we try to gain self-value by showing partiality, we attract people who devalue us, manipulate us, and judge us based on man-made or cultural laws.

I once heard an acclaimed expert on self-esteem say that we know something is wrong in our culture when a child's value is determined by the words printed on her tennis shoes. Many adults use the same criteria to determine how much they esteem both themselves and others. They are looking for an exceptional ATM. They are not looking at a person's effort to grow the Fruit of the Spirit in their life.

Let's skip down a bit in this same chapter to where James talks about faith, or trust, and real virtue.

<sup>14</sup>What use is it, my siblings, if someone says that he trusts God but makes no effort to contribute to the community? Can that trust save him? <sup>15</sup>If a brother or sister is without clothing and in need of daily food, <sup>16</sup>and one of you says to them, "Go in peace, be warmed and be filled," and yet you do not give them what is necessary for their body, what use is that? <sup>17</sup>Even so, faith or trust, if we make no effort to help, is dead, being only words and illusions.

Take a deep breath.

If we are deluded enough to trust money more than we trust God, we will feel insecure whether we have money or not. We will therefore create virtue stories that justify our hoarding and will reckon as virtue generous intentions that never translate into substantial action. Every kind of hoarding and greed stifles the karis economy within our community.

When we claim to trust God but refuse to act on that trust, we are living in an illusion. James is telling us a simple truth: *Only action is action (Repeat)*, and our action reveals the quality of our faith, or trust. God is not telling us to give to every poor person or to every cause. He is telling us to support the community of spiritually committed brothers and sisters with whom we experience various levels of karis relationship. These are the people who show by their choices that they trust God and are making real efforts to grow into the possibilities of that trust.

Our prayer might go something like this.

*Lord, teach me to take real action that reveals the quality of my trust in You. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?" )*

## **1:10 INTEGRATION**

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. Assume a meditation posture, and breathe.  
*(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider revealing what you believe through your actions. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **The FAITH Process**

*(Choose from each section a few sentences that are meaningful to you)*

#### **Feelings**

As you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions*, breathe and recognize any feelings or any resistance that may be present. *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. Just observe your experience with compassion, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Awareness without judgment**

Allow whatever you are experiencing to rest in your awareness. You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. You might struggle with feeling anything at all. Simply observe your experience as you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions*. *(Pause)* Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Inquiry: What is my body saying?**

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing when you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions*. *(Pause)* Acknowledge any sensations you may feel. *(Pause)* Observe and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Talk to Jesus**

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions*. Do you feel comfortable, uncomfortable, or do you feel nothing at all? Just observe. *(Pause)* Do you feel compelled to judge this revelation as good or bad? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of something? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Observe your experience as just information. You might process with a long exhaling breath, or the Dragon Breath.<sup>6</sup> *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Heal**

God created human beings to have feelings about everything. Feelings are chemical reactions in our bodies bringing us information. You can choose to honor and observe your feelings without reacting to them. We all have to learn to experience our feelings and, at the same time, choose to live oriented lives. *(Pause)* The fact that you can step back and observe your experience lets you know that your experience does not define you; you are separate from your experience. *(Pause)* When a feeling signals you through the body, you can focus on your body and your breath rather than reacting and getting caught up in a story. Breathe with compassion for everyone who is learning to deal with what is revealed about their beliefs. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take a deep breath

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")*

## **1:28 ENDING PRAYER**

Dear Father and Creator,

We are grateful for this time to heal and train together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You continue to show us the truth about ourselves. Help us learn to trust You as we use our real resources to serve. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and mission, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.



*(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?”)*

## **1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS**

\*This is the time in our KF training cycle to consider whether we, as KF members, have the MATH to offer the next NHG book study to our wider community. All current members are invited to participate in offering this gift by signing up on the spreadsheet in the recent email sent from admin.

(\*Except when preparing for the Jubilee year)

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<sup>1</sup> [nutritiousmovement.com](http://nutritiousmovement.com).

<sup>2</sup> [www.centeringprayer.com](http://www.centeringprayer.com).

<sup>3</sup> Eph. 4:28.

<sup>4</sup> [en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tapas\\_Acupressure\\_Technique](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tapas_Acupressure_Technique).

<sup>5</sup> James 1:17.

<sup>6</sup> See KF12.